

Know Your Rights: Police Encounters

Pocket Guide for Stops, Searches, & Arrests

I. Stopped by Police

Am I free to go? If yes, walk away. If no, you are being detained. Under the law, officers need reasonable suspicion of a crime.

II. Search Defense

Clearly assert: 'I do not consent to searches.' This protects your legal defense in court if they search you anyway.

III. The Right to Remain Silent

Assert: 'I am exercising my right to remain silent and want to speak to a lawyer.' Then, stop talking immediately.

IV. If You Are Arrested

Do not physically resist, but do not answer any questions without an attorney present. Request your phone call.

Radiant Threshold · Injustice Reform Network

This document is free and open-source for community organizers, licensed under Creative Commons. Access more at the resources directory.